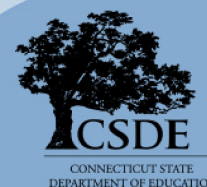


DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



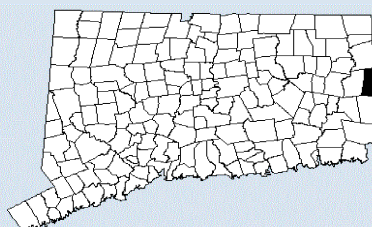
Sterling School District

Dr. Gail Lanza, Superintendent • 860-564-4219 • <http://www.sterlingschool.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-8
Number of Schools/Programs	1
Enrollment	312
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$16,189
Total Expenditures ¹	\$8,564,105

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	140	44.9	48.4
Male	172	55.1	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	*	*	5.2
Black or African American	*	*	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	27	8.7	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	20	6.4	4.0
White	255	81.7	49.9
English Learners	0	0.0	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	109	34.9	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	51	16.3	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	50	37.9	*	*
Male	57	35.0	*	*
Black or African American	*	*	0	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	7	29.2	*	*
White	81	33.3	*	*
English Learners	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	54	52.4	7	6.1
Students with Disabilities	23	46.0	*	*
District	107	36.3	13	3.9
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 11

Number of school-based arrests: 0

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Sterling School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	24.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	5.7
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	4.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	16.6
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	1.0
School Level	1.5
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	1.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	1.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	1.5
School Nurses	1.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	26.9

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.3
Black or African American	0	0.0	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	0	0.0	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.1
White	34	100.0	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	5.9	7.3

Instruction and Resources

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers²

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	*	*
Emotional Disturbance	*	*
Intellectual Disability	0	0
Learning Disability	15	*
Other Health Impairment	10	*
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	9	*
District	41	62.1
State		67.9

² This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Sterling School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	9	2.1	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	7	1.6	1.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*	0.5
Learning Disability	19	4.4	5.8
Other Health Impairment	13	3.0	3.3
Other Disabilities	*	*	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	13	3.0	1.9
All Disabilities	68	15.9	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	*	*	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	*	*	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$6,361,098	\$12,025	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$85,103	\$236	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$231,555	\$643	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$210,199	\$584	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$359,144	\$998	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$104,264	\$290	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$468,181	\$1,301	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$654,495	\$1,134	\$1,159
Food services	\$25,203	\$70	\$21
Enterprise operations	\$64,863	\$180	\$151
Total	\$8,564,105	\$16,189	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$600,395	23.4	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$351,886	13.7	11.1
Other Salaries	\$94,118	3.7	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$283,851	11.1	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$28,542	1.1	5.4
Special Education Tuition	\$1,179,603	46.0	22.5
Supplies	\$23,080	0.9	0.5
Property Services	\$1,500	0.1	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$691	0.0	7.2
Equipment	\$2,417	0.1	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$229	0.0	0.1
Total	\$2,566,312	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		30.0	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	56.4
State	40.0
Federal	2.7
Tuition & Other	0.9

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Sterling School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Sterling School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	36.3%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	47.3%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	.	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	N/A	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		90.0%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		.	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		.	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		.	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		.	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	.	.	.	.	.

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Sterling School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Sterling School district employs reading and math specialist supports and social emotional supports for students. The District has a comprehensive school SRBI framework and supports that are data informed and take into consideration proactive strategies to address student needs throughout all tiers of instruction. The District has developed a Strategic Plan that includes personalized learning for students and staff as a focus, and that emphasizes student competencies and progressions as communicated via learning targets and individual goal setting with students and staff.

The District has made efforts to improve student attendance. The truancy committee meets regularly to review attendance data and remediate attendance concerns in a timely manner. The truancy committee includes school administration and the school nurse who plan action steps to support families with school attendance.

In an effort to engage parents in the planning and improvement of school programs, parents continue to be invited to participate on committees that seek to advance the goals of the District Strategic Plan. Parents' input is sought when rolling out new initiatives and feedback is solicited via surveys, newsletters and social media. The District continues to improve the website to make it more user friendly for parents, students, staff, and community members.

The District works to support parents at home by encouraging regular communication and collaboration with families. Teachers reach out regularly to parents via emails, newsletters, and phone calls to communicate what is happening in the classroom settings as well as to provide assistance and guidance to parents in areas where they may be seeking assistance, such as homework, understanding developmental milestones and learning progressions, essential learning standards and mastery based learning expectations.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Sterling Community School continues to provide content and curriculum that increases student awareness of cultural and individual diversity. Curriculum provides a focus on world culture and customs. In addition, the District continues to implement SEL curriculum and content that draws from the core CASEL competencies in an effort to improve overall social awareness, self-awareness, relationship skills and responsible decision making all through a lens of empathy and compassion for others.

Events are scheduled throughout the year to promote and celebrate diversity that is aligned with the District's curriculum standards.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Sterling School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Not applicable